

AUTHENTICATION CONCEPTS

View online: <https://www.construct.net/en/game-services/manuals/game-services/authentication/concepts>

What is the Authentication Service?

When you **create a game**, you will need to **register players** or allow players to **sign in** the game before they can interact with features in other services that require a player account.

Once a player is registered or signed in, a session key will be returned for this player. Passing this session key into other services allows this player to interact with other Construct Game Services. **The session key is private to this player and should never be shared or exposed.**

All players have a unique **player ID** which is a **guid**. Players also have a **player name** which can be displayed publicly. If a player signs in with a username and password it should be noted that the **username** is different to the **player name** and is only used to authenticate the sign in.

Registering Players

There are two ways to register players:

- Specific call to the **register player** end point
- **Signing in a player** with a supported **login provider**

If you register a player manually and **don't** provide a username and password, if the session key expires or is lost this player account will be unrecoverable. It is advised if possible to encourage the player to set a username/password, or **link to a login provider** at some point to ensure they can use this newly created account.

When a player **signs in** with a login provider, a new player will be registered if this player has not previously signed into your game. If the player has previously signed in with this login provider, a new session key will be generated which ties them to their already established player ID.